

The Best Way to Learn Container and Cloud Native Technologies

Companies are today looking for people skilled in container and cloud native technologies. In case you want to acquire these skills, make sure you do so the right way.



The 10th Annual Open Source Job Report received from the Linux Foundation (<https://www.linuxfoundation.org/research/the-10th-annual-open-source-jobs-report>) makes it evident that container and cloud native skills are the most in demand (Figure 1). Let's first try to understand the scope of technologies covered under the umbrella term cloud native.

The Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF) defines cloud native computing as the use of open source software, as well as technologies such as containers, microservices and service mesh, to develop and deploy scalable applications on cloud computing platforms.

The topics covered under cloud native are hence very vast, including the knowledge of different cloud computing platforms like AWS, Azure, Google Cloud, etc. If you want a list of the different tools and projects that are used under the hood of cloud native deployment, you can refer to <https://landscape.cncf.io/card-mode?project=hosted>.

There is no way one can master all of these. Such a breadth of topics overwhelms the learner, and creates confusion on where and how to begin as well. At the same time, if the basics are right, learning these topics does not take much time.

So, before learning about containers and cloud native technologies, one needs to make sure one's foundation is very strong. By this I mean one should have a sound understanding of the following:

- Operating system and networking concepts
- Working knowledge of Linux
- Working knowledge of Git and GitHub
- General understanding of cloud and DevOps

One cannot skip or jump directly into advanced topics. The topics listed above are generally taught in colleges these days, but if you have not learned them earlier, there are many resources available — both online and offline.